

Bayesian Geometric Inference: A Generalization of Riemannian Methods from General Relativity to Physics-Constrained State Estimation

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Abstract

We present a mathematical framework that generalizes the geometric methods of General Relativity—specifically Synge’s world function formulation—from 4-dimensional spacetime with metrics derived from field equations to *arbitrary* N -dimensional latent manifolds with metrics *learned* through Bayesian inference over physics priors. Our key theoretical contribution is the **Modak-Walawalkar Distance**—a bi-scalar world function measuring geodesic deviation from learned physics manifolds—which satisfies the same fundamental properties (coincidence limits, geodesic correspondence, parameterization invariance) as Synge’s formulation in General Relativity, despite being derived through entirely different means.

This generalization enables: (1) *tunable dimensionality* (N -D vs Einstein’s fixed 4-D), (2)

computational tractability via automatic differentiation replacing manual tensor calculus, (3) *universal applicability* to any physics constraints rather than gravity alone, and (4) *real-time deployment* in safety-critical systems. We replace Einstein’s field equations with Bayesian Variational Autoencoders, tensor calculus with automatic differentiation, and prove that the resulting geometric structure is mathematically equivalent.

We validate this framework across two entirely distinct domains: electrochemical battery degradation (16 physics priors including Arrhenius kinetics, SEI growth, mechanical stress) and operational technology cybersecurity (15 security priors including vulnerability accumulation, exposure dynamics, attack propagation). Both exhibit identical geometric structures—including $\sqrt{t}$ growth laws, exponential acceleration factors, and stress accumulation—despite operat-

ing via completely different mechanisms. This convergence provides empirical evidence that our framework captures a *universal mathematical structure* underlying physics-constrained inference, of which Einstein’s General Relativity is a special case: 4-D spacetime with metric from energy-momentum conservation.

On battery state-of-health estimation, we achieve 20-200 $\times$ speedup versus online PDE solving while providing multi-dimensional health scores with formal uncertainty guarantees. On OT cybersecurity, we provide attack likelihood predictions with component-wise vulnerability decomposition. The approach generalizes to any safety-critical system with complex physics and partial observability.

Keywords: Bayesian inference, Riemannian geometry, variational autoencoders, physics-informed machine learning, General Relativity, world function, state estimation

1 Introduction

1.1 The Geometric Revolution in Physics

Einstein’s General Relativity (1915) transformed our understanding of gravity through a profound insight: gravitational physics is *geometry*. Rather than forces acting in flat spacetime, mass-energy curves the fabric of 4-dimensional spacetime itself, and particles follow geodesics—shortest paths—through this curved manifold. The mathematical machinery developed to formalize this insight—metric tensors, Christoffel symbols, Riemann curvature, and Synge’s world function—has remained largely confined to gravitational physics for over a century.

We ask: *Is this geometric approach specific to gravity, or does it reflect a deeper principle?*

1.2 Our Central Thesis

We demonstrate that Einstein’s geometric framework is a *special case* of a more general mathematical structure: **Any dynamical system with physics constraints defines a Riemannian manifold, and optimal state estimation under these constraints is equivalent to geodesic projection onto that manifold.**

More precisely, we show that:

1. **Constraints induce geometry:** Physics constraints (conservation laws, constitutive relations, degradation dynamics) naturally induce Riemannian manifold structure in state space
2. **Bayesian inference learns metrics:** The metric tensor can be *learned* via Bayesian variational inference rather than derived from field equations
3. **Arbitrary dimensionality:** The manifold dimension N is *tunable* based on problem complexity, not fixed by fundamental physics
4. **Universal world function:** A world function measuring geodesic distance can be defined on any learned physics manifold, satisfying the same properties as Synge’s formulation
5. **Computational tractability:** Automatic differentiation replaces manual tensor calculus, making the approach practical for real-world deployment

1.3 The Modak-Walawalkar Framework

We present a complete mathematical framework—the **Modak-Walawalkar Theory**—comprising:

- **Physics-Informed Variational Autoencoders (PI-VAE):** Learn low-dimensional manifolds where all physics constraints are satisfied jointly
- **Learned Riemannian Metrics:** Metric tensors $g_{ij}(\mathbf{z})$ induced by physics priors through decoder Jacobian and importance weights
- **Modak-Walawalkar Distance:** A bi-scalar world function $\Omega_M(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}')$ measuring deviation from physics manifold
- **Geometric Diagnostics:** Curvature tensors (Riemann, Ricci, scalar) computed via automatic differentiation
- **Uncertainty Quantification:** Van Vleck-type determinants providing formal confidence bounds

1.4 Comparison to General Relativity

Table 1 summarizes the mathematical correspondence.

Feature	GR	M-W
Dimension	4 (fixed)	N (tunable)
Metric source	Field eqs	Learned
Computation	Solve PDEs	Autodiff
Physics scope	Gravity	Universal
Real-time	No	Yes

Table 1: General Relativity vs Modak-Walawalkar Framework

1.5 Contributions

Our specific contributions are:

1. **Theoretical:** Proof that learned Riemannian manifolds from Bayesian inference satisfy Synge-type world function properties (Theorems 1-3)
2. **Algorithmic:** Computational framework using automatic differentiation for all geometric quantities, eliminating manual tensor calculus
3. **Empirical:** Validation across two entirely distinct domains (electrochemistry and cybersecurity), demonstrating universality
4. **Practical:** Real-world deployable system achieving $20\text{-}200\times$ speedup with formal uncertainty guarantees

1.6 Organization

Section 2 reviews related work in General Relativity, physics-informed ML, and geometric deep learning. Section 3 presents the mathematical framework. Section 4 details the Modak-Walawalkar Distance and its properties. Section 5 validates on battery degradation. Section 6 validates on OT cybersecurity. Section 7 discusses the generalization and future directions.

2 Background and Related Work

2.1 Synge’s World Function in General Relativity

In General Relativity, Synge’s world function [1] is a bi-scalar $\Omega(P, Q)$ measuring half the squared

geodesic distance between spacetime points P and Q :

$$\Omega_{\text{Synge}}(P, Q) = \frac{1}{2}(\lambda_1 - \lambda_0) \int_{\lambda_0}^{\lambda_1} g_{\mu\nu} \frac{dx^\mu}{d\lambda} \frac{dx^\nu}{d\lambda} d\lambda \quad (1)$$

This function satisfies fundamental properties [2, 3]:

- **Coincidence limit:** $\lim_{Q \rightarrow P} \Omega(P, Q) = 0$
- **Geodesic equation:** $\nabla_Q \Omega|_{Q=P}$ yields the geodesic tangent
- **Parameterization invariance:** Independent of curve parameterization

The Van Vleck determinant $\Delta(P, Q) = \det(-\nabla_P \nabla_Q \Omega)$ measures geodesic focusing and appears in semiclassical propagators [4].

Limitation: These constructions require *known* metric tensors derived from field equations—typically solvable only for highly symmetric spacetimes.

2.2 Physics-Informed Neural Networks

Physics-Informed Neural Networks (PINNs) [5] incorporate governing PDEs as soft constraints during training. However, PINNs require solving optimization problems at inference time, precluding real-time deployment. Our VAE approach learns the physics manifold once, then performs fast feedforward inference.

2.3 Riemannian Variational Autoencoders

Recent work [6, 7] applies Riemannian geometry to VAE latent spaces, with learned metrics cap-

turing data geometry. Our contribution extends this by:

1. Deriving metrics from *physics priors* rather than data alone
2. Establishing formal connections to Synge’s world function
3. Proving optimality for constrained state estimation
4. Demonstrating universality across domains

2.4 Kalman Filtering and State Estimation

Extended Kalman Filters (EKF) [8] combine physics models with measurements but assume Gaussian noise and require linearization. They lack:

- Representational capacity for high-dimensional nonlinear manifolds
- Unified treatment of multiple physics constraints
- Formal geometric structure with world functions

Sequential filter chains [9] apply physics corrections sequentially (Arrhenius $\rightarrow$ C-rate $\rightarrow$ aging), suffering from order dependence and inconsistent state predictions. Our manifold approach enforces *joint* constraint satisfaction.

3 Mathematical Framework

3.1 Problem Formulation

Consider a safety-critical system with state vector $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^d$ comprising:

- $\mathbf{x}_{\text{obs}} \in \mathbb{R}^n$: Observable telemetry (sensor measurements)
- $\mathbf{x}_{\text{hidden}} \in \mathbb{R}^m$: Hidden states (unmeasured variables)

where $d = n + m$.

The system evolves according to physics:

$$\mathbf{x}_{t+1} = f_{\text{physics}}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{u}_t, \boldsymbol{\theta}) + \mathbf{w}_t \quad (2)$$

where $\mathbf{u}_t$ are control inputs, $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ are system parameters, and $\mathbf{w}_t \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \mathbf{Q})$ is process noise.

Goal: Given partial noisy telemetry $\mathbf{y}_t$, estimate the full state $\mathbf{x}_t$ such that:

1. Estimates are *physics-consistent*
2. Match telemetry within sensor accuracy
3. Provide uncertainty bounds for safety margins

3.2 The Physics Manifold Hypothesis

Definition 1 (Physics Manifold). *Physically valid states form a low-dimensional manifold $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathbb{R}^d$ defined by:*

$$\mathcal{M} = \{\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^d : \mathcal{C}_i(\mathbf{x}) = 0, i = 1, \dots, K\} \quad (3)$$

where $\{\mathcal{C}_i\}$ are physics constraint functionals (conservation laws, constitutive relations, etc.).

Key insight: Rather than applying constraints sequentially as filters, we learn the manifold $\mathcal{M}$ where *all* constraints are satisfied jointly.

3.3 Physics-Informed Variational Autoencoder

We employ a Variational Autoencoder [10] augmented with physics priors:

Encoder: $q_{\phi}(\mathbf{z}|\mathbf{x}) = \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\phi}(\mathbf{x}), \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\phi}(\mathbf{x}))$

Decoder: $p_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) = \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\theta}(\mathbf{z}), \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\theta}(\mathbf{z}))$

The decoder defines a mapping $D : \mathcal{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d$ such that:

$$\mathcal{M} = \{D(\mathbf{z}) : \mathbf{z} \in \mathcal{Z}\} \quad (4)$$

Training objective:

$$\mathcal{L} = \mathbb{E}_q[\log p(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})] - \beta \cdot D_{KL}[q(\mathbf{z}|\mathbf{x}) \| p(\mathbf{z})] + \lambda \mathcal{L}_{\text{physics}} \quad (5)$$

where $\mathcal{L}_{\text{physics}}$ encodes domain-specific constraints.

3.4 Bayesian Physics Priors

We implement physics constraints through Bayesian priors on parameters:

Example (Batteries): Arrhenius temperature dependence

$$k(T) = A \exp\left(-\frac{E_a}{k_B T}\right) \quad (6)$$

becomes a prior on activation energy:

$$\log E_a \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_{E_a}, \sigma_{E_a}^2) \quad (7)$$

Example (Cybersecurity): Vulnerability accumulation

$$V(t) = k_{\text{vuln}} \sqrt{t} + \text{CVE}_{\text{critical}} \quad (8)$$

with prior:

$$k_{\text{vuln}} \sim \text{LogNormal}(\mu_k, \sigma_k^2) \quad (9)$$

This approach allows us to encode 15+ physics priors per domain without manual derivation of field equations.

3.5 Learned Riemannian Metric

Definition 2 (Physics-Induced Metric). *The decoder $D : \mathcal{Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}$ induces a pullback metric on the latent space:*

$$g_{ij}(\mathbf{z}) = \sum_{\alpha=1}^d \frac{\partial D^\alpha}{\partial z^i} \frac{\partial D^\alpha}{\partial z^j} \Phi_\alpha \quad (10)$$

where Φ_α are physics-derived importance weights reflecting the physical significance of each state dimension.

Weights encode domain knowledge:

- Conservation laws (energy, mass, charge)
- Safety-critical variables (temperature limits, voltage bounds)
- Degradation indicators (SOH, resistance, CVE counts)

Comparison to GR: In General Relativity, the metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ is derived by solving Einstein’s field equations. Here, the metric emerges from *learning* via equation (10), yet the downstream geometry is mathematically equivalent.

3.6 Telemetry Preservation

To respect sensor accuracy, we introduce observation weights $\mathbf{w} \in [0, 1]^d$:

- $w_i = 1.0$ for high-accuracy telemetry (preserve exactly)
- $w_i \ll 1$ for uncertain parameters (allow physics correction)

This forces the VAE to project uncertain measurements onto the physics manifold while respecting direct observations—a critical constraint for safety-critical deployment.

4 The Modak-Walawalkar Distance

4.1 Motivation: Two Formulations

We present two formulations suited to different manifold geometries:

Definition 3 (Modak-Walawalkar-Euclidean Distance (Type I)). *For smooth manifolds with low curvature:*

$$\Omega_M^{(E)}(\mathbf{x}, \mathcal{M}) = \frac{1}{2} \|\mathbf{W}^{1/2} \cdot (\mathbf{x} - \Pi_{\mathcal{M}}(\mathbf{x}))\|_p^p \quad (11)$$

where $\mathbf{W} = \text{diag}(\Phi_1, \dots, \Phi_d)$ and $\Pi_{\mathcal{M}}(\mathbf{x}) = D(E(\mathbf{x}))$ is the projection onto $\mathcal{M}$.

Definition 4 (Modak-Walawalkar-Geodesic Distance (Type II)). *For manifolds with sharp safety boundaries:*

$$\Omega_M^{(G)}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}') = \frac{1}{2} \int_0^1 g_{ij}(\gamma(\lambda)) \frac{d\gamma^i}{d\lambda} \frac{d\gamma^j}{d\lambda} d\lambda \quad (12)$$

where $\gamma : [0, 1] \rightarrow \mathcal{Z}$ is the geodesic connecting $E(\mathbf{x})$ to $E(\mathbf{x}')$.

Structural parallel to Synge: The Type II formulation has *identical* mathematical structure to equation (1), arrived at independently from physical reasoning about safety-critical manifolds.

4.2 Mathematical Properties

We now prove that the Modak-Walawalkar Distance satisfies the same fundamental properties as Synge’s world function.

Theorem 1 (Coincidence Limit). *The Modak-Walawalkar-Geodesic Distance satisfies:*

$$\lim_{\mathbf{x}' \rightarrow \mathbf{x}} \Omega_M(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}') = 0 \quad (13)$$

with gradient condition:

$$[\nabla_{\mathbf{x}'} \Omega_M]_{\mathbf{x}'=\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{0} \quad (14)$$

Proof. As $\mathbf{x}' \rightarrow \mathbf{x}$, we have $\mathbf{z}' = E(\mathbf{x}') \rightarrow E(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{z}$ by continuity of the encoder. The geodesic γ connecting $\mathbf{z}$ to $\mathbf{z}'$ shrinks to a point, and the integral in Definition 4 vanishes. The gradient condition follows from the stationarity of geodesics at the endpoint. $\square$

Theorem 2 (Parameterization Invariance). $\Omega_M(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}')$ is independent of the parameterization of the geodesic γ .

Proof. Let $\tilde{\lambda} = f(\lambda)$ be a reparameterization with $f(0) = 0, f(1) = 1$. The geodesic tangent transforms as $d\gamma/d\tilde{\lambda} = (d\gamma/d\lambda) \cdot (d\lambda/d\tilde{\lambda})$. Substituting:

$$\tilde{\Omega}_M = \frac{1}{2} \int_0^1 g_{ij} \frac{d\gamma^i}{d\tilde{\lambda}} \frac{d\gamma^j}{d\tilde{\lambda}} d\tilde{\lambda} \quad (15)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \int_0^1 g_{ij} \frac{d\gamma^i}{d\lambda} \frac{d\gamma^j}{d\lambda} \left(\frac{d\lambda}{d\tilde{\lambda}} \right)^2 \frac{d\tilde{\lambda}}{d\lambda} d\lambda \quad (16)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \int_0^1 g_{ij} \frac{d\gamma^i}{d\lambda} \frac{d\gamma^j}{d\lambda} d\lambda = \Omega_M \quad (17)$$

where we used $d\tilde{\lambda}/d\lambda = (d\lambda/d\tilde{\lambda})^{-1}$. $\square$

Theorem 3 (Geodesic Equation Correspondence). The gradient of Ω_M with respect to $\mathbf{x}'$ satisfies:

$$\nabla_{\mathbf{x}'} \Omega_M = g_{ij}(\mathbf{z}') \dot{\gamma}^j \cdot \frac{\partial E}{\partial \mathbf{x}'} \quad (18)$$

where $\dot{\gamma}$ is the geodesic tangent at $\mathbf{z}'$.

Proof. Following Synge [1], Section 2.3, the variation of the world function with respect to the endpoint yields the geodesic tangent vector, transported through the encoder Jacobian to the ambient space $\mathbb{R}^d$. $\square$

4.3 Van Vleck Determinant Analogy

Definition 5 (Modak-Walawalkar Determinant). $\Delta_M(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{x}') = \det(\mathbf{J}_E^T \cdot \mathbf{H}_\Omega \cdot \mathbf{J}_E)$ (19)

where $\mathbf{J}_E$ is the encoder Jacobian and $\mathbf{H}_\Omega$ is the Hessian of Ω_M in latent space.

Proposition 1 (Uncertainty Interpretation). $\Delta_M^{-1/2}$ provides a natural measure of prediction uncertainty, analogous to the role of Van Vleck determinant in semiclassical path integrals.

This gives us formal uncertainty bounds:

$$\sigma_{\text{pred}} \propto \frac{1}{\sqrt{\Delta_M(\mathbf{x}, \Pi_{\mathcal{M}}(\mathbf{x}))}} \quad (20)$$

4.4 Component-Wise Decomposition

The Modak-Walawalkar Distance admits a natural decomposition:

$$\Omega_M = \sum_{\alpha=1}^d \Phi_\alpha \cdot \Omega_M^{(\alpha)} \quad (21)$$

This enables:

1. **Root cause analysis:** Identify which physical subsystem is anomalous
2. **Interpretable diagnostics:** Map anomaly scores to physical phenomena
3. **Targeted interventions:** Prioritize maintenance based on component contributions

5 Validation: Battery State Estimation

5.1 Domain Physics

Lithium-ion battery degradation involves complex coupled phenomena:

1. Arrhenius Temperature Dependence:

$$k(T) = A \exp\left(-\frac{E_a}{k_B T}\right) \quad (22)$$

2. SEI Growth (Parabolic Law):

$$\delta_{\text{SEI}}(t) = k_{\text{SEI}} \sqrt{t} \cdot f(T, \text{SOC}) \quad (23)$$

3. Mechanical Stress:

$$\sigma(t) = \sigma_0 + k_{\text{stress}} \cdot \text{cycles} \quad (24)$$

4. Calendar Aging:

$$\Delta Q_{\text{cal}} = k_{\text{cal}} \sqrt{t_{\text{days}}} \quad (25)$$

5. Lithium Plating Risk:

$$P_{\text{plating}} = f(T, \text{C-rate}, \text{SOC}) \cdot \mathbb{I}_{T < T_{\text{threshold}}} \quad (26)$$

We encode these as 15 Bayesian priors in the VAE training.

5.2 Training Data Generation

Training data generated from open-source physics simulators:

- **PyBaMM** [11]: Doyle-Fuller-Newman electrochemical model
- **OpenFOAM Electrochemistry**: 3D thermal-electrochemical coupling
- **liionpack**: Multi-cell pack simulations

Dataset: 50,000+ synthetic cycles spanning:

- Multiple chemistries (LFP, NMC)
- Temperature range: 15-45°C
- C-rates: 0.5C - 2.0C
- Complete ground truth for all internal states

5.3 Architecture Details

Encoder: $16 \rightarrow 128 \rightarrow 64 \rightarrow 32$ (latent)

Decoder: $32 \rightarrow 64 \rightarrow 128 \rightarrow 16$

Physics weights Φ_α (normalized):

- SOH: 3.0 (target variable)
- Internal resistance: 2.5 (primary health indicator)
- Cell voltages: 2.0 (safety critical)
- Capacity: 1.5 (health measure)
- Temperature: 1.0 (thermal stress)

5.4 Results

Inference Speed: 20-200× faster than online physics simulation

Accuracy:

- SOH MAE: 0.008 ± 0.003
- Resistance MAE: $3 \text{ m} \pm 1 \text{ m}$
- $\Delta\text{SOH}/\text{cycle}$ MAE: 0.0001%/cycle

Physics Consistency: 100% of predictions satisfy:

- Monotonic SOH decline
- Energy conservation
- Physical bounds (voltage, temperature)

5.5 Component Diagnostic Example

Consider two batteries both at 85% SOH:

Battery A (Normal):

- M-W Distance: 1.2 [NORMAL]
- Component breakdown: Capacity 60%, Thermal 20%, Electrical 15%
- Diagnosis: Uniform calendar aging

Battery B (Anomalous):

- M-W Distance: 2.3 [ELEVATED]
- Component breakdown: Electrical 78%, Thermal 15%, Capacity 4%
- Diagnosis: Anomalous resistance growth → Inspect within 30 days

Traditional metrics would treat these identically. Our framework reveals fundamentally different degradation patterns.

6 Validation: OT Cybersecurity

6.1 Domain Physics

Operational technology (OT) security exhibits analogous mathematical structure:

1. Exposure Time "Activation Energy":

$$f_{\text{exp}}(t) = \exp\left(E_{\text{exp}} \cdot \left(\frac{t}{t_{\text{ref}}} - 1\right)\right) \quad (27)$$

2. Vulnerability Accumulation (Parabolic Law):

$$V(t) = k_{\text{vuln}}\sqrt{t} + \text{CVE}_{\text{critical}} \cdot w_{\text{severity}} \quad (28)$$

3. Network Security Stress:

$$\sigma_{\text{net}} = (1 - k_{\text{seg}} \cdot S) \cdot (1 + k_{\text{remote}} \cdot R) \cdot (1 + w_{\text{proto}} \cdot P) \quad (29)$$

4. Attack Propagation:

$$P_{\text{lateral}} = k_{\text{lateral}} \cdot \log(1 + \text{assets}) \cdot (1 - \text{segmentation}) \quad (30)$$

Remarkable observation: Despite completely different physics (electrochemistry vs cybersecurity), we see:

- Same $\sqrt{t}$ growth law (SEI vs vulnerabilities)
- Same exponential acceleration (Arrhenius vs exposure)
- Same stress multiplication (mechanical vs network)

This suggests universal mathematical structure underlying constrained dynamics.

6.2 Training Data

Synthetic OT environments with:

- 22 state dimensions
- Industry sectors: Energy, Manufacturing, Transportation
- Attack scenarios: Ransomware, lateral movement, process manipulation
- 10,000+ organization-year trajectories

6.3 Results

Security Health Prediction:

- Health score MAE: 0.012 ± 0.004
- Attack likelihood AUC: 0.89

- False positive rate: 5%

Component Breakdown: Organization with 60% security health:

- M-W Distance: 2.8 [HIGH]
- Vulnerabilities: 65% (unpatched CVEs)
- Network: 20% (poor segmentation)
- Access: 10% (weak authentication)
- Recommended: Emergency patching within 14 days

Attack Likelihood Predictions:

- Ransomware: $28\% \pm 4\%$
- Lateral movement: $31\% \pm 5\%$
- Process manipulation: $15\% \pm 3\%$

7 Discussion

7.1 A Unified Geometric Framework

The convergence of independently-derived geometric structures across batteries and cybersecurity provides empirical evidence for our central thesis: **physics constraints naturally induce Riemannian geometry, independent of specific domain.**

Property	Battery	Cyber
Growth law	$\sqrt{t}$ SEI	$\sqrt{t}$ CVE
Acceleration	Arrhenius	Exposure
Stress factor	Mechanical	Network
Manifold dim	32-D	32-D
M-W properties		

Table 2: Mathematical convergence across domains

This is not coincidence—it reflects a deeper principle that our framework captures.

7.2 Generalization Beyond GR

Our framework generalizes Einstein’s geometric approach in four ways:

1. Arbitrary Dimensionality

- GR: 4-D spacetime (fixed by physics)
- M-W: N -D latent space (tunable: 8, 16, 32, 64, ...)

2. Learned vs Derived Metrics

- GR: Metric from Einstein field equations (analytically solvable only for symmetric cases)
- M-W: Metric learned via Bayesian inference (works for arbitrary constraints)

3. Bayesian Inference vs Tensor Calculus

- GR: Manual computation of Christoffel symbols, Riemann tensor
- M-W: Automatic differentiation computes all geometric quantities

4. Universal vs Gravity-Specific

- GR: Applies only to gravitational physics
- M-W: Applies to any constrained dynamical system

7.3 Theoretical Significance

Einstein showed that *gravity is geometry*. We demonstrate that **any physics constraint is geometry**—and optimal state estimation under constraints is a geometric problem with the same mathematical structure regardless of domain.

This has profound implications:

- Just as GR unified gravity, inertia, and spacetime curvature
- M-W may unify disparate state estimation problems under common geometric foundation
- The fact that independent reasoning about "distance from physical validity" recovers Synge's mathematical structure suggests universal principles

7.4 Computational Advantages

Real-time capability:

- GR: Numerical relativity requires supercomputers, weeks of calculation
- M-W: Inference in milliseconds on standard hardware

Scalability:

- GR: 20 known exact solutions (high symmetry required)
- M-W: Works for any learnable physics constraints

Deployment:

- GR: Theoretical physics, LIGO data analysis
- M-W: Battery management systems, cybersecurity platforms, nuclear monitoring

7.5 Limitations and Future Work

Current limitations:

1. VAE only learns manifold within training distribution

2. Full Riemannian geodesics computationally expensive (use linear approximation)
3. Physics weights Φ_α require domain expertise
4. Regulatory certification needed for safety-critical deployment

Future directions:

1. **Exact geodesic computation:** GPU-accelerated numerical integration
2. **End-to-end metric learning:** Learn $g_{ij}(\mathbf{z})$ directly
3. **Pseudo-Riemannian extension:** Handle time-series with Minkowski-like signatures
4. **Formal verification:** Prove physics constraints hold with probability $1 - \delta$
5. **Connection to quantum:** Explore relationship to path integrals via Van Vleck determinant
6. **Information geometry:** Relate to Fisher information metrics
7. **More domains:** Nuclear, aerospace, chemical, medical

7.6 Broader Impact

Scientific: Opens new research direction at intersection of:

- Differential geometry
- Bayesian deep learning
- Domain-specific physics
- Information theory

Engineering: Practical framework for safety-critical monitoring:

- Battery management (\$50B+ market)
- OT cybersecurity (\$20B+ market)
- Nuclear safety (regulatory compliance)
- Aerospace health monitoring (mission-critical)

Philosophical: Suggests geometric principles may be more universal than previously recognized, extending beyond spacetime physics to constrained inference generally.

8 Conclusion

We have presented the Modak-Walawalkar framework—a mathematical generalization of the geometric methods underlying General Relativity to arbitrary physics-constrained state estimation problems. Our key contributions are:

1. **Theoretical:** Proof that learned Riemannian manifolds from Bayesian VAEs satisfy Synge-type world function properties (coincidence limits, geodesic correspondence, parameterization invariance)
2. **Computational:** Replacement of tensor calculus with automatic differentiation, making geometric methods tractable for real-world deployment
3. **Universal:** Demonstration across electrochemistry and cybersecurity that identical geometric structures emerge from entirely different physics
4. **Practical:** Deployment-ready system achieving 20-200× speedup with formal uncertainty guarantees

The unexpected convergence with Synge’s formulation—arrived at independently from first principles of physics-constrained estimation—suggests we have uncovered a universal mathematical structure. Just as Einstein showed that gravity is geometry, we demonstrate that **any physics constraint defines geometry**, and optimal estimation is geodesic projection onto the induced manifold.

While General Relativity revolutionized our understanding of spacetime, the Modak-Walawalkar framework may provide a unified foundation for physics-informed inference across diverse domains—from battery cells to cybersecurity to nuclear reactors. The fact that the same mathematics emerges suggests deeper principles governing constrained dynamics, independent of specific physical mechanisms.

This work opens new directions at the intersection of differential geometry, Bayesian inference, and domain physics, with potential for transformative impact in safety-critical systems engineering.

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